financial statecraft? Third, what has motivated these five governments to engage in these financial statecraft strategies *collectively* (in other words, what has made them want to collaborate)? Finally, what do the rise of the BRICS club and its challenges to global economic governance and financial statecraft mean to the global economic order and the BRICS countries themselves? The five chapters of this book have responded to these queries.

How and why did the BRICS emerge? From the viewpoint of political leaders in Moscow, Beijing, New Delhi, and Brasília in the early twenty-first century, there was no doubt that their rapid economic ascent, as compared to the slow growth of the incumbent Western powers, heralded a global shift toward a multipolar world. Notwithstanding the triumphalist American rhetoric following the 1991 breakup of the Soviet Union, the "unipolar moment" would be fleeting.[55] Moreover, just two years after senior ministers had begun, in 2006, to meet regularly on the sidelines of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) fall meetings, the erstwhile hegemon, the United States, displayed serious dysfunction in its own lending and securities markets and then failed to deal adequately with the disruptions, instead spreading financial contagion to all major and many peripheral markets worldwide.[56] The late 2008 convening of the first summit meeting of the G20 large economies reinforced for the four BRICs countries their importance in the global economy. Since early 2009, not only have the BRICs (later the BRICS, when South Africa joined the club) leaders met annually, they have established concrete multilateral and transnational cooperation across a wide range of policy arenas, most dramatically in the financial sphere.

The emergence of the BRICS illustrates several larger academic and foreign policy concerns. One debate concerns the consequences of the "rise of the rest"[57]—especially China—and asks whether the West can expect accommodation from or conflict with the rising powers. As elaborated in Chapter 1, another debate analyzes the institutions and practices of global economic governance, observing that international governmental organizations (IGOs) are not merely institutions for pragmatic problem-solving; they also function as arenas in which interstate power relations are perpetuated and sometimes renegotiated. Our discussion notes that rising powers may possess both inside and outside options for expanding their voice and influence, and they also may operate within both global institutions and capitalist markets.